Kristen Stopfer

CURRICULUM VITAE

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EDUCATION

2030 PhD in Human Development and Family Sciences
Texas Tech University

2027 M. A. in Human Development and Family Sciences
Texas Tech University

2024 B. S. in Psychology
B. A. in Political Science
Minor in Latin
University of Pittsburgh Honors College | *Summa cum laude*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Stress, Aging, Cardiovascular system, Immunology, Bereavement, Social relationships

PUBLICATIONS

2. DuPont, C. M., Weis, T. M., King, J. A., **Stopfer, K. T.**, Clayton, C. K., Marsland, A. L., Kamarck, T. W., Gianaros, P. J., & Scudder, M. R. (2026). Dual-impedance cardiography for the assessment of arterial stiffness: associations with blood pressure, cardiometabolic risk factors, and preclinical atherosclerosis in midlife adults. *Blood Pressure*, *35*(1). https://doi.org/10.1080/08037051.2025.2600733
1. Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K.**, DeCataldo, M., Marsland, A., Muldoon, M., Scudder, M., Gianaros, P. (2025) Functional and Circulating Indicators of Endothelial Health and their Associations with the American Heart Association's Life's Essential 8. *American Journal of Lifestyle Medicine.* doi:10.1177/15598276251408755

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

5. **Stopfer, K.**, Brown, R. L., & Weiser, D. *Queering Widowhood* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
4. **Stopfer, K.**, Knauft, K., Girod, S., & Brown, R. L. *Early Life Indicators of CVD Risk: Examining Perceived Stress, Blood Pressure, and Blood Pressure Variability Across the Life Course* [Thesis in preparation]. Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
3. Li, J., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M., **Stopfer, K.,** Lindsay, E *Cardiovascular relaxation during guided paced breathing: Associations with childhood abuse and subclinical vascular health.* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Psychology, University of Pittsburgh; Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
2. Biancamano, D., **Stopfer, K.**, Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. *Associations Between Coping Strategy Variability and Cardiac Autonomic Activity* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Psychology, Florida State University; Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University; Department of Psychology, University of Pittsburgh
1. **Stopfer, K.**, Cirillo, J., DeCataldo, M., DuPont, C., Brown, R. L., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. *Autonomic Correlates of Subclinical CVD in Midlife Adults* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Human

Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University; Department of Psychology, University of Pittsburgh

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Under Review

2. **Stopfer, K.,** Wiley, C., Tomiyama, J., Laraia, B., Epel, E., Brown, R. L. (2027, March 17-20). *Early Life Indicators of CVD Risk: Perceived Stress, Blood Pressure, and Blood Pressure Variability Across the Life Course in the NHLBI Growth and Health Study.* [Abstract submitted]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 84th Annual Scientific Meeting, New Orleans, US.
1. Li, J., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M., **Stopfer, K.,** Lindsay, E. (2027, March 17-20). *Cardiovascular relaxation during guided paced breathing: Associations with childhood abuse and subclinical vascular health.* [Abstract submitted]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 84th Annual Scientific Meeting, New Orleans, US.

POSTERS

8. Sun, J., **Stopfer, K.,** DeCataldo, M., Kraynak, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2026, March 11-14). *Cardiac Autonomic Correlates of High-Field (7T) MRI Markers of Cerebrovascular Health and Brain Aging* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 83rd Annual Scientific Meeting, Chicago, US.
7. Biancamano, D., **Stopfer, K.**, Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2026, March 11-14). *Associations Between Coping Strategy Variability and Cardiac Autonomic Activity* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 83rd Annual Scientific Meeting, Chicago, US.
6. **Stopfer, K.,** Cirillo, J., DeCataldo, M., DuPont, C., Brown, R. L., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2026, March 11-14). *Autonomic correlates of subclinical CVD* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 83rd Annual Scientific Meeting, Chicago, US.
5. **Stopfer, K.**, Cirillo, J., Reeves, K., King, J., Kamarck, T., Inagaki, T. K., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2025, March 19-22). *Associations between Social Loss and Blood Pressure in Midlife Adults* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 82nd Annual Scientific Meeting, Seattle, US.
4. Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K.**, Reeves, K., King, J., Muldoon, M., Marsland, A., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2025, March 19-22). *Functional and Biological Indicators of Endothelial Function and their Association with the AHA Life's Essential 8* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 82nd Annual Scientific Meeting, Seattle, US.
3. Luisi, A., Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K**., King, J., Reeves, K., Bhatt, A., Farago, C., Kamarck, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2024, March 20-23). *A comparison of the test-retest reliability of noninvasive endothelial function measures* [Poster presentation]. American Psychosomatic Society 81st Annual Scientific Meeting, Brighton, UK.
2. Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K.**, Luisi, A., King, J., Reeves, K., Bhatt, A., Farago, C., Kamarck, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2024, March 20-23). *A novel measure of endothelial function using forearm impedance cardiography* [Poster presentation]. American Psychosomatic Society 81st Annual Scientific Meeting, Brighton, UK.
1. **Stopfer, K.**, King, J., Luisi, A., Cirillo, J., Reeves, K., Bhatt, A., Farago, C., Kamarck, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2024, March 20-23). *Longitudinal and multiyear progression of arterial stiffness measured by dual impedance cardiography* [Poster presentation]. American Psychosomatic Society 81st Annual Scientific Meeting, Brighton, UK. ***Citation Poster**

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2026-present Society of Behavioral Medicine (SBM)
2025-present Psychoneuroimmunology Research Society (PNIRS)
2025-present Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine (SBSM)
2023-present Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society

2023-present Eta Sigma Phi Classics Honor Society
2023-present Pi Sigma Alpha Political Science Honor Society
2022-present Psi Chi Psychology Honor Society
2022-present Epsilon Eta Delta Environmental Honors Fraternity

SERVICE ACTIVITIES

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2026-present **Member** | **Excellence & Innovation Committee**
Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University

2026-present **Secretary** | **Graduate Student Association**
Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University

2025-present **Chair** | **Climate, Health, and Sustainability Special Interest Group**
Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine (SBSM)

2025-present **Member** | **Access and Opportunity Committee**
Psychoneuroimmunology Research Society (PNIRS)

2025-present **Member** | **Emerging Leaders Special Interest Group – Resources Subcommittee**
Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine (SBSM)

2023-2024 **Chair** | **Epsilon Eta Delta Environmental Honors Fraternity**
University of Pittsburgh

COMMUNITY SERVICE

April 2026 **Tech-Lubbock Community Day** (4 hours)
Texas Tech University

Nov. 2025 **Center for Early Head Start Toy Drive** (4 hours)
Texas Tech University

Jan. 2023, 24 **MLK Day of Service** (10 hours)
University of Pittsburgh

2021-2023 **Pitt Dance Marathon** (120 hours) | *Staff member*
University of Pittsburgh

March 2023 **Alternative Spring Break** (40 hours)
San Cristóbal Island, Ecuador**;** University of Pittsburgh

Aug. 2022 **Pitt Arrival Volunteer** (12 hours)
University of Pittsburgh

AWARDS AND HONORS

2026-2027 **UWC Paul Whitfield Horn Fellowship** ($1000), Texas Tech University

2026-2027 **Mary T. Young Scholarship** ($474), Texas Tech University

2026-2027 **Dr. William J. Carter Scholarship** ($1,026), Texas Tech University

2025-2026 **HDFS General Scholarship** ($3,000), Texas Tech University

2024 **Citation Poster**, Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine

2023-2024 **Honors College Scholarship** ($2,500), University of Pittsburgh

2023-2024 **Panthers Forward Scholar** ($5,000), University of Pittsburgh

2020-2024 **Dean's List,** University of Pittsburgh

2020-2024 **National Merit Scholarship** ($8,000)

2020 **American Association of University Women Scholarship** ($2,500), Easton, PA Branch

2020 **General Federation of Women's Clubs Pennsylvania Scholarship** ($1,000), Bangor, PA Branch

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2026-present **Parenting and Early Development (PEDs) Lab** | Texas Tech University
Advisor: Dr. Savannah Girod
Role: Graduate Researcher (Volunteer)
Responsibilities:

- Train lab members in psychophysiology methods, including ECG, ICG, and EDA
- Integrate psychophysiology measures into REDCap for data management

2025-present **Stress, Aging, and Relationships (STAR) Lab** | Texas Tech University
Advisor: Dr. Ryan Linn Brown
Role: Graduate Researcher
Responsibilities:

- Collaborate with colleagues to establish new research lab and lay the groundwork for future studies
- Lead and write IRB protocol for a project examining psychophysiology in dyads, specifically in caregivers and their spouses who have Alzheimer's disease and related dementias (ADRD)
- Create and lead a cross-institutional journal club centered around providing accessible psychophysiology training for trainees and PIs alike
- Provide psychophysiology training to fellow lab members and collaborators, including dyadic ECG, ICG, continuous BP, and EDA

2022-2025 **Laboratory for Psychophysiology and Health Neuroscience** | University of Pittsburgh
Advisors: Drs. Pete Gianaros and Mark Scudder
Role: Clinical Research Assistant
Responsibilities:

- Administered psychophysiology measures including electrocardiography (ECG), dual impedance cardiography (d-ICG), continuous blood pressure monitoring, and venous occlusion plethysmography (VOP)
- Administered and scored neuropsychological and stress tasks including the Montreal cognitive assessment (MoCA), digit symbol substitution (DSST), multi-source inference task (MSIT), Stroop, Verbal Fluency, Spatial Recognition Task (SRT), Flanker, Digit Vigilance Task (DVT), and the Paced Auditory Serial Addition Task (PASAT)
- Trained 14 undergraduates in psychophysiology and neuropsychological assessment administration
- Assisted MRI technicians and spoke with participants while they were undergoing MRI protocols
- Scored all psychophysiological data across 4 studies in Mindware software to prepare data for analysis

- Led 3 independent projects, which involved idea conception, data analysis, and scientific writing

SKILLS

- Statistical analysis & coding (R, SPSS, Mplus)
- Mindware data scoring (HRV, IMP, BPV)
- Web design (HTML, CSS, JavaScript)

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

2026-present **STEM Center for Outreach, Research, and Education**
Role: Graduate Mentor
Responsibilities:

- Meet twice monthly with mentees to create individualized timelines to reach specific academic and professional goals
- Foster development of strong academic and research reading & writing skills
- Support professional development by connecting mentees with opportunities and guiding their efforts

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026 **"Lifespan Development"** | Texas Tech University
Instructor: Dr. Ryan Brown
Role: Graduate Teaching Assistant
Responsibilities:

- Assisted students with course-related questions to promote learning and growth
- Created quiz and exam questions to reflect the key takeaways of the course content
- Created & lead in-class activities
- Ensured grading was completed in a timely manner
- Managed technical difficulties related to the Canvas platform and coordinated with students to ensure they can access course content
- Ensured Canvas page meets accessibility requirements

2025 **"Family in the Community" & "Community Practicum"** | Texas Tech University
Instructor: Dr. Shera Thomas-Jackson
Role: Graduate Teaching Assistant
Responsibilities:

- Guest lectured on logic models as a useful tool in assessing community projects
- Led panel discussions on community practicum opportunities
- Supported students by assisting with questions related to course material and/or their community partners
- Provided detailed individualized feedback on assignments to promote growth and learning
- Coordinated with instructor to promote clear and efficient dissemination of information as students navigate a new course platform

2022 **"Introduction to Neuroscience"** | University of Pittsburgh

Instructor: Dr. Lisa McIllvried
Role: Undergraduate Teaching Assistant
Responsibilities:

- Supported students with content comprehension and study strategies during class and office hours
- Created a detailed presentation and conducted a review session to ensure students felt confident leading up to their exam
- Ensured lectures and exam sessions ran smoothly by collaborating with the instructor and assisting students wherever needed

OUTREACH AND ENGAGEMENT

2025-present **Psychophysiology Journal Club**
Role: Creator & organizer
Description: Cross-institutional journal club promoting scholarship and training related to psychophysiology
Presented five times

2024-present **Psychoneuroimmunology Journal Club**
Role: Regular attendee
Description: Pittsburgh-based cross-institutional journal club exploring new research published on PNI
Presented once

2026 **STEM Center for Outreach, Research, and Education – Summer Camp**
Role: Summer Camp Assistant
Responsibilities:

- Assisted in lesson plan and camp activity preparation
- Designed camp materials in Canva to have a cohesive and engaging style
- Aided teachers in lesson facilitation
- Helped campers complete activities centered around surviving in the wilderness and forensic science